

Strategies for Azure storage account backups

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Strategies

1. Introduction

- Purpose of the document
- Importance of data protection in cloud environments

2. Overview of Azure Storage Account Types

- Blob, File, Disk, Table, Queue
- Storage tiers and replication options (LRS, ZRS, GRS, RA-GRS)

3. Backup Strategy Categories

- Operational Backup
- Vaulted Backup
- Snapshots and Archive Tier
- Third-party integrations (e.g., Rubrik, DPM)

4. Operational Backup

- Local backup within the source storage account
- Retention up to 360 days
- Restore to source only
- Soft delete recommendation
- [Microsoft Docs Reference](#)

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5. Vaulted Backup

- Offsite backup to Backup Vault
- Retention up to 10 years
- Restore to alternate storage accounts
- Object replication and recovery point creation
- [Microsoft Docs Reference](#)

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6. Snapshots and Archive Tier

- Incremental snapshots for disks and blobs
- Archive tier for long-term storage
- Use cases for disaster recovery and compliance
- [Internal Reference: [Azure Backup L300 Customer Deck](#)]

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7. Backup for Azure Files and Disks

- Azure Files backup process
- Disk backup via agent-less snapshots
- Retention and automation support
- [Internal Reference: [Attaching Azure Backup and ASR Chalk & Talk](#)]

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8. Security and Compliance

- Encryption at rest and in transit
- Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)
- Immutable backups and retention locks
- [Internal Reference: Module 1 - Azure Backup]

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9. Backup Management Tools

- Backup Center
- Azure Portal, CLI, SDK
- Monitoring and alerts
- [Internal Reference: BCDR with Azure Backup and Site Recovery]

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10. Advanced Scenarios

- Azure Data Lake Storage Vaulted Backup (Preview)
- Object replication and container-level policies
- [Microsoft Docs Reference](#)
- [Internal Reference: Draft : Vaulted Backups for Azure Data Lake Storage]

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11. Third-Party and Hybrid Solutions

- Rubrik appliance integration
- Microsoft DPM + third-party storage
- ROBO and regional DC strategies
- [Internal Reference: [\[EXTERNAL\] RE: Azure stack backup solution by Microsoft](#)]

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12. Best Practices and Recommendations

- Backup policy design
- Avoiding restore conflicts
- Testing and dry runs
- [Microsoft Docs Reference](#)

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13. Conclusion

- Summary of strategies
- Choosing the right solution based on workload and compliance needs

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